

Kaden Grace

Department of Economics | University of Tennessee | Knoxville, TN 37919

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DOCTORAL STUDIES

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Ph.D., Economics 2027 (expected)

M.A., Economics 2024

Dissertation Committee and References:

Matt Harris (Chair)

Department of Economics

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

E-mail: mharris@utk.edu

Seth Neller

Department of Economics

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

E-mail: sneller@utk.edu

Christian Vossler

Department of Economics

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

E-mail: cvossler@utk.edu

Jason Lindo

School of Economics

Georgia Institute of Technology

E-mail: jlindo@gatech.edu

PRIOR EDUCATION

University of Mississippi

B.S., Economics 2022

B.A., Mathematics 2022

Honors: *summa cum laude*, Phi Kappa Phi

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Primary: Public Economics, Health Economics

Secondary: Labor Economics, Behavioral and Experimental Economics

WORKING PAPERS

“The Eyes of Texas are Upon OB/GYNs: Physician Migration and Crowdsourced Enforcement of Abortion Regulations”

(Job Market Paper)

Abstract: This paper studies the labor market effects of civil liability enforcement using Texas Senate Bill 8 (SB-8, 2021) as a natural experiment. A civil liability enforcement mechanism in this context allows any citizen to sue anyone who “aids or abets” a prohibited abortion for minimum damages of \$10,000. This “bounty law” lowers the evidentiary burden and expands the pool of potentially liable individuals, which raises expected operating costs and could incentivize out-migration for a broad set of physicians compared to traditional criminal enforcement. We exploit variation across physician specialties, states, and time in a triple-difference design, comparing reproductive health physicians to all other physicians in Texas against similarly abortion-hostile states before and after SB-8’s signing. Using a Medicare administrative provider panel of approximately 1.4 million physicians (2007–2022) and Wagescape job posting data (2016–2022), we find that reproductive health physicians did not leave Texas at differential rates following SB-8. The null result is consistent with the high fixed cost of interstate relocation, estimated at \$150,000 to \$250,000. Neither posted salaries nor job posting volume for

reproductive health providers changed differentially. Our findings are corroborated by synthetic difference-in-differences and synthetic control estimators and provide a contrast to prominent media narratives of a large OB/GYN exodus from Texas. We contribute to a rapidly emerging literature by providing evidence that civil liability enforcement had no detectable effect on the Texas physician labor market above and beyond the broader abortion policy environment.

“Saving for a Rainy Day: Experimental Evidence on Prize-Linked Saving and Financial Shocks” (*Under Review*)

WORKS IN PROGRESS **“The Economic Impact of Unemployment Insurance Reform in Tennessee”**

PRESENTATIONS	ISEO Summer School, Iseo, Italy	June 2026
	American Society of Health Economists (ASHECON) Annual Conference	June 2026
	Veritas Forum	June 2026
	Society of Government Economists Annual Conference	April 2026
	Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2025
	American Society of Health Economists (ASHECON) Annual Conference	2025
	UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar	2024, 2025
	UTK Experiment and Theory Group Workshop	2023
	UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop	2023, 2024
UTK Graduate Student Research Seminar	2022–2023	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE **University of Tennessee – Knoxville**

Instructor of Record

ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Summer 2026
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ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2026
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Teaching Assistant (Graduate)

ECON 211: Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
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ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2023
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ECON 581: Mathematical Methods in Economics	Fall 2023
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FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS	Best Second-Year Thesis	2024
	Best First-Year Graduate Student	2023
	Walter Melville Bonham PhD Fellowship	2024
	J. Fred & Wilma Holly PhD Fellowship	2024
	Joseph & Barbara O'Donnell PhD Fellowship	2023
	Haslam Excellence Doctoral Fellowship	2022–2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Research Assistant (Graduate)	2023–2025
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University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Conducted advanced public and behavioral economics research using causal inference in experimental settings. Managed and analyzed data for ongoing research projects, informing policy recommendations. Collaborated with faculty to design experiments evaluating welfare impacts of financial products on low-income households.

Experimental Lab Manager 2023–2026

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Led setup and execution of economic experiments, ensuring data integrity and accuracy. Coordinated participant recruitment, data collection, and analysis across a research team.

DATA SKILLS Causal inference in experimental and quasi-experimental settings: A/B testing, randomized controlled trials, differences-in-differences, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity. Data scraping, cleaning, and visualization using Stata, R, Python, and Excel. Advanced regression and time-series analysis. Machine learning methods, forecasting, GMM, GLS, and discrete choice modeling.

AFFILIATIONS Student Representative, Campus Advisory Board 2025–2026
Chairperson, Doctoral Student Association 2023–2024
Organizer, Graduate Student Research Seminar 2023–2025
Member: Society of Government Economists | Southern Economic Association | American Society of Health Economists

LANGUAGES English (native) | French (fluent) | Spanish (basic) | German (basic)

Updated: June 17, 2026